



2 Min Review: Harriet Powers, Pictorial Quilt



02:00

Appetizer

- Most paintings were produced by men
 - Women mostly did art in other ways (sewing & needlepoint)
- Quilts: treasured family objects, some even signed w/ the quilter(their name was a part of the design), often seen in wills and passed down through generations
- Quilts were more popular bc. of industrialization
- 19th-century quilts had three layers: quilt top, an inner layer, and a backing



Appetizer (part 2)

- Born enslaved in Georgia, 1837, Harriet later married Armstead Powers, and had > nine children
- Became landowners after they were freed
- Her gravestone, found in Athens' Gospel Pilgrim Cemetery, gives her death date as January 1st 1910
- Harriet Powers made the Pictorial Quilt, now in the collection of the Museum of Fine Arts in Boston



Main Course

- Cotton plain weave, pieced, appliqued, embroidered, 175 x 266.7 cm
- storytelling is similar to textiles from Dahomey
- most panels are people and scenes from The Bible
- meteor storms of 1833 and 1846 and “Black Friday” of 1780, when smoke from forest fires made the sky go dark
- A panel tells the story of a hog that ran from Georgia to Virginia
- The center panel is the Leonid meteor storm on November 13, 1833



Thank You!

